

MEMORY DOCS

Part One: 'Every Living Day'

a pilot for an original series by

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EXT. KAZ DAĞLARI, TURKEY - DAY

The doorless jeep zips along the ancient mountain ridges.

APOLLO (V.O.)
We each have our stories.

Sitting shotgun, a WOMAN with a straw-sized gap in her teeth aims an early-90s camcorder out the side. Hunting for crumbs of civilizations hiding in the sun-charred olive groves.

APOLLO (V.O.)
Some are fact. Most are fiction.

When the sturdy trees begin to SHAKE at their roots, she knows it's too late for the road. RUMBLING from below--

FLIPS THE JEEP sideways down a hill until it--

CRUNCHES a small house. The camcorder ejects out the open side and lands facing the wreckage. Jeep out of shot.

APOLLO (V.O.)
But they are all real.

ON CAMCORDER

Bloodied, the woman rushes to a trapped little GIRL. As she pulls her out, she spots something GREEN in the rubble...

APOLLO (V.O.)
Alone, they're incomplete. It's the
fragments connected we call truth.
And to build it, all we must do is--

INT. OLD TV STUDIO - DAY (2002)

The EYES of DR. APOLLO DAY glimmer under stage lights.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
--open our eyes.

This gray fox in tailored scrubs gesticulates like a preacher with lean, elegant limbs.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
This show has has one mission: to
empower you: to control your life,
your health. I'm not here to tell
you *what to think*. No. I simply
show you *how to look*. So that we
may all discover together.

He takes in APPLAUSE with his award-winning ivory grin.

DARCY (PRE-LAP)
And after 20 years, we're still
discovering with my guest today,
Dr. Apollo.

INT. APOLLO'S STUDIO - STAGE - DAY (PRESENT DAY)

Talkshow host DARCY (50s) interviews Apollo at his home studio in Del Mar, CA. Now in his 70s, he still radiates comforting authority in a crisp white lab coat.

DARCY (CONT'D)
How do you feel looking back at
that first episode of OUR DAY?

APOLLO
Honestly, Darcy? Ancient.

DARCY
Yet you still look fantastic.

APOLLO
And I do my best to welcome all
perspectives.

The old pros exchange a knowing chuckle.

DARCY
Let's talk perspectives. Pew says
your America's most trusted voice
on health. I guess that's no
surprise for a triple-board
certified neurosurgeon with a name
on a top wellness brand and a face
on TV. But many in the scientific
community view you with - not just
skepticism - but outright contempt.
What do you say to those critics?

APOLLO
Thank you.

He laces his trusty fingers, leans into the surprise:

APOLLO (CONT'D)
Science is conflict, Darcy.
Competing evidence. Versions of
events. Visions of the future. Like
I said in that very first episode,
we each have our fragments of
reality.

APOLLO (CONT'D)

And we need them *all* to construct the truth. Not in spite of, but because of the differences. And that requires open minds. And it requires the humility to say:

VERA (PRE-LAP)

I don't know.

APOLLO (CONT'D)

I. Don't. Know.

INT. FAIRDRUG PHARMACY - REGISTER - DAY

VERA (27, small frame, big brain) helps a crusty CUSTOMER holding a bottle of DayPur vitamins.

CUSTOMER

Lady. Do they work or not?

VERA

You should talk to a doctor.

He points to her nametag: Dr. Vera Kartal, PhD.

VERA (CONT'D)

Oh. Yeah. No. I'm not that kind.

CUSTOMER

You're not a real doctor?

Vera grits teeth in smile formation.

VERA

I just can't tell you what to take.

CUSTOMER

Then why do you work here?

She blinks - holding dark eyes closed extra long. Trying to keep thoughts to herself these days. But he's asking...

VERA

If you want my honest opinion, most vitamins are bullshit.

CUSTOMER

But he said take two a day.

He points to TV behind her--

ON TV: the Apollo/Darcy interview.

Vera can't hold in the SCOFF.

CUSTOMER (CONT'D)
Lemme guess. Another honest
opinion?

VERA
The man is a classic charlatan. He
sells you what he recommends.

CUSTOMER
He gave the president a physical.

VERA
So you'll listen to anyone who
touches the president's dick?

Customer recedes with offense. She went too far.

VERA (CONT'D)
Sorry. I'm just saying: he's human.

INT. APOLLO'S STUDIO - OFFICE - DAY

Apollo glowers at his BRAIN SCAN on a wall-mounted MONITOR.
RED SPLOTCHES are growing.
Disease is taking hold.

INT. CHARY'S OFFICE - DAY

CHARY DAY (40s, Black) lays down the law to a STAFFER.

CHARY
This is not a negotiation. State
Senator Lee made a commitment.

STAFFER
Chary. Pharma will shit themselves.

CHARY
Your primary opponent sees that as
a feature, not a bug.

Staffer clams up.

STAFFER
You're talking to Mahar?

Blithe, Chary stretches thick arms, sealed in airtight suit,
above a sign on the wall: INSTITUTE FOR VISIONARY MEDICINE.

Staffer slowly accepts this is not, in fact, a negotiation.

INT. APOLLO'S STUDIO - DAY

MILA DAY (25, insta-fab spirit goddess with Apollo's lively eyes) entertains a fawning member of the interview's TV CREW.

CREW

...legit changed my life. I watch
your live streams like every day.

Mila beams. Loves hearing her impact on fans. Leans in:

MILA

So tell me. When did you lose him?

Crew's face drops. But before they can share the sob story--

CHARY (O.S.)

Mila. Dad says he needs us.

Chary appears behind her. Nods for her to follow him to:

APOLLO'S OFFICE

Apollo quickly kills the monitor as Chary and Mila enter.

APOLLO

How was it upstairs with Lee's guy?

CHARY

Stick worked. No carrots needed.

Apollo nods, half proud. Mila fixes makeup in mirror.

MILA

Dad. I'm live in 20. What is this?
(turning, concerned)
It's not like your health, right?

APOLLO

God no. It's just all this
anniversary hoopla. It's gotten me
thinking...about the family. I was
considering that perhaps the second
half of the interview tonight is a
good opportunity to put it all out
there. To talk about...her.

Corner of Mila's lip drifts up. Chary's brow folds intensely.

INT. FAIRDRUG PHARMACY - BACK OFFICE - NIGHT

Vera takes a video interview with a PROFESSOR on her laptop.

VERA

Thanks for making the time. I know it's really early in Singapore.

PROFESSOR (ON LAPTOP)

It's noon here, Vera. Anyway--
(let's get this over with)
Impressive resume. Finished the PhD quite young. Some strong, if brief, clinical research experience. But a substantial gap since then...

Vera opens mouth to explain, but--

MANAGER (O.S.)

Vera!

She lowers laptop, swings to her MANAGER. Whispers:

VERA

Fuck, Judy. I'm in the middle of something.

MANAGER

Yeah, you're in the middle of your shift. I told you: if you're gonna work here, you need to *work here*.
(storming back out)
Take interviews on your own time.

Vera breathes, settles. Opens laptop with a smile:

VERA

So sorry about tha--

BLANK SCREEN. Interview over. She tries to calm herself--

SWIPES the laptop onto the floor.

BATHROOM

Vera polishes off a stolen beer. Reviews EMAILS on her PHONE:

- "Thank you for your application, but--"
- "Unfortunately, we've already filled--"
- "Checking Account - OVERDRAFT ALERT"

Looks up to mirror. Simmers at herself. CRUSHES the can.

INT. APOLLO'S STUDIO - STAGE - NIGHT

Darcy and Apollo continue part two of the live interview.

DARCY
You're known to keep family close.

APOLLO
Certainly. Mila's in the poolhouse,
Chary's office is upstairs, and my
grandson is just down the street.
I'm blessed to have every Day here.

DARCY
But not every Day is...

INT. FAIRDRUG PHARMACY - REGISTER - NIGHT

Vera returns to the register. GROANS when she hears the
Apollo/Darcy interview back on TV behind her.

DARCY (O.S.)
Apollo. You've never spoken about
this publicly. What happened?

APOLLO (O.S.)
We always saw things different. But
losing her mom...it was too much.
Anger consumed her. And, she left.

Scans next item: bottle of DayPur vitamins. DOUBLE GROAN.

INT. APOLLO'S STUDIO - STAGE - NIGHT

Darcy leans in for the kill. Apollo's ready. He always is.

DARCY
If you could say anything to her
right now, what would you say?

APOLLO
I love you.

INT. FAIRDRUG PHARMACY - REGISTER - NIGHT

CLOSE-UP of Apollo's face on TV:

APOLLO
Please come home.

Vitamin bottle SMASHES INTO TV - cracking his face.

BOTTLE POPS open on floor...

PILLS SPRAY at the feet of the heaving, hawing Vera.

INT. APOLLO'S STUDIO - OFFICE - NIGHT

Apollo watches an old episode of OUR DAY.

ON TV: The younger Apollo and a TEEN GIRL cook pancakes.

BZZZ. Apollo picks up his phone. Listens. Lips part slowly.

INT. FAIRDRUG PHARMACY - NIGHT

The Manager leads Apollo through an empty shop in LA.

MANAGER

...had no idea she was yours until
we processed the termination.

APOLLO

Relax. She uses her mom's name for
a reason. No special treatment.

MANAGER

Well. She's lucky to have you here.

Apollo smiles, gracious. He knows how to take a complement.

VERA (PRE-LAP)

What the fuck are you doing here?

BACK OFFICE

Vera simmers in a plastic chair, arms folded. Apollo stands.

APOLLO

They're a big DayPur buyer. Only
reason they didn't press charges.

VERA

Well I'm not going home with you.

APOLLO

Dinner then. Anywhere you want.

VERA

After you lied about me on TV?

APOLLO

Lied? Maybe I remember differently.

VERA

Then you need to fix your brain.

She watches his face darken. He knows. And soon she will too.

INT. SPORTS BAR - NIGHT

Apollo, champion of plant-based diets, GAGS at the sight of Vera devouring buffalo wings. She bristles at his judgement.

VERA
It's chicken.

APOLLO
Pumped with antibiotics,
hormones...the inflammation will--

VERA
According to who? What studies?

Eyes meet with hostility. But now is not the time.

VERA (CONT'D)
You said "anywhere I want".

APOLLO
Like those places in LA no one can
afford until their parents visit.

VERA
Well I can't afford this place. But
it always makes me feel better.

APOLLO
Does that mean you actually care?

Vera's jaw locks. Of course she cares. *Right?*

VERA
Just tell me. How bad is it?

APOLLO
There's time to figure it out.

VERA
Figure what out? There's no cure--

APOLLO
No. Not yet.

She snorts at the arrogance. A server plops down VODKA SODA.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
Poison won't make you feel better.

VERA
At least it makes me feel less.
(big slurp through straw)
So. What do the others think?

APOLLO
Vera. No one else knows.

VERA
What? Not even Chary? Or Mila?

Apollo avers his eyes. She's astonished.

VERA (CONT'D)
Why? Are you...embarrassed? Afraid
they might see you like I do?

APOLLO
And how is it you see me, Vera?

VERA
As human. Mortal. Self-deluding.

APOLLO
Deluding myself? About what?

Vera evades with a sip. Now is *really* not the time.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
So you say it behind my back. But
face to face it's just...chicken?

She almost chuckles. But he's serious. Now may be the only
time. She leans onto her elbows. Whispers forcefully:

VERA
You think you're this...*maverick*.
But you're just another huckster.
Pushing snake oil and false hope to
the desperate and naïve.

APOLLO
Please. You assume people are naïve
because it makes you feel smart.

VERA
No, I *assume that* because people
like you feed them horseshit. And
close them off to real knowledge--

APOLLO
I give them opportunity. To see. To
find other ways of knowing. *You're*
the one closed off. Locked so deep
in your own prison of certainty--

VERA
So what? You're gonna bust me out?
Change my mind for me?

APOLLO
I'd rather open it. So you can
tolerate me. Before it's too late.

Liquor's burned her shell. Letting guilt sting. She pleads:

VERA
Just tell me what you want.

APOLLO
A week.

Her brows fold slowly.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
The show has some time off. I
thought we could use it as an...
experiment. One week at home. To
see my work. To be with your
family. And maybe, just maybe, open
your eyes to new possibilities.

VERA
Dad. It's been six years. Why would
I do that now?

APOLLO
Because this isn't just my last
shot, Vera.

He grabs her drink. Pounds it. Looks her dead in the eyes.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
It's yours too.

INT. OLD TV STUDIO - DAY

Apollo holds up a chocolate chip cookie.

APOLLO
Memories aren't fully baked. They
don't even exist in one place.
Instead, they're stored as tiny
pieces throughout the brain.

He drops cookie dough on a table. Picks out CHOCOLATE CHIPS.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
To remember, we *re-collect* these
fragments and construct them into
coherent narratives.

Dips fingers in green food coloring. Grabs chocolate chips.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
 Meaning: we don't *have* memories--

Chocolate chips melt as he molds them into a GREEN BALL.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
We make them. Each time, they're colored and shaped a little different. And while this means they're all, to some degree, *false* - it doesn't reduce their power. No. What you remember is always real.

INT. VERA'S APARTMENT - DAY

REVEAL Vera streams the old episode of OUR DAY on her phone--

APOLLO (ON PHONE) (CONT'D)
 Even if it's not true.

--as she empties vodka into a water bottle.

RINGING interrupts video.

Vera picks up, frantic. Talks as she stuffs the filled bottles under her clothes in a duffel bag.

VERA
 Dude. I called you like 30 times.

INT. UNIVERSITY - SILAS'S OFFICE - DAY

PROFESSOR SILAS KARTAL (40s, tiny but shredded) snacks as he talks to his cousin, Vera, on speakerphone.

SILAS
 I know. I was teaching. What kind of lunatic leaves voicemails?

VERA (V.O.)
 Lunatics with time sensitive issues, Silas. He's sending a car now to take me there for dinner.

SILAS
 Wait. You're not seriously considering this, are you?

INT. VERA'S APARTMENT - DAY

Vera doesn't know how to answer--

SLIAS (V.O.)
 You know what he is. You know what
 he's done. And you definitely know
 you can't trust him...right?

She's saved by a BEEP.

Peels curtains: limo's here.

SUNNY (PRE-LAP)
 We all make our choices.

INT. PODCAST STUDIO - DAY

SUNNY DAY (19, tribal tats covering hulking frame) records
 with podcasting meatsauce JIM LOGAN.

SUNNY (CONT'D)
 Who and what to believe in.

LOGAN
 So do you trust the experts?

SUNNY
 Some. But they're just people, Jim.

The crystal-laden wiz kid is a ringer for his grandfather,
 Apollo, but looks nothing like his dad, Chary.

SUNNY (CONT'D)
 Think about this. They say to only
 use what's proven in randomized
 clinical trials. But then they push
 SSRI's like Prozac that *aren't*
 shown to be more effective than
 placebo in those *same* trials.

LOGAN
 Is that true? Jake, look that up.

Logan nods to his producer off-set. Lights a joint.

LOGAN (CONT'D)
 I mean, I know those drugs
 absolutely WRECK your dick.

SUNNY
 Exactly. Yet they only go after the
 psychotropics, the nootropics -
 basically any of the biohacking
 solutions I recommend. Because
 they're afraid of losing their
 monopoly on the truth.

Logan coughs out smoke. Losing track of the conversation.

LOGAN

You know I was watching your
sister's medium videos. Pretty
wacky stuff. But kinda cool.

SUNNY

You mean my aunt, Mila.

LOGAN

Sorry, yeah. I should have her on.
Is she into all this shit too?

Passes Sunny the joint, who inhales as he speaks:

SUNNY

She does like *spiritual* stuff.

Blows out a CLOUD...

INT./EXT. LIMO - SUNSET

REVEAL Vera watches Sunny's interview on her phone in the
back of her dad's limo.

SUNNY (ON PHONE)

I'm more focused on reality.

Vera snorts.

PAUSE. Scrolls recommended videos with Sunny's face:
motivational speeches, festivals, podcasts...

Until the app starts recommending videos with MILA'S FACE.

SIGH. Opens MESSAGES. Scrolls. Scrolls. Scrolls. All the way
down to her thread with Mila:

It's mostly Mila's unrequited birthday greetings over the
last six years. And other messages Vera ignored, like:

- "Hey! I was just thinking about you. Maybe we can chat--"
- "I know you don't want to hear from me, but I'm in LA--"
- "You're not being fair to dad OR me. I know you think what
I'm doing is crazy or bad or whatever, but mom says--"

Tosses phone. She'll deal with this in reality soon enough.

INT. DAY HOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT

CHOP. CRACK. SIZZLE. Chary, furious, helps Apollo cook.

CHARY

So you want us to forget everything
she said about you? About us?

APOLLO

No. I'm *telling* you to make her
feel at home. And to mix the fruit.
(shouting aimlessly)
And I need radish!

RITA, the live-in helper, offers a hand.

APOLLO (CONT'D)

Thanks, Rita. But my children
agreed to help tonight. Right?

Chary flips on a fruit-stuffed blender. GRRRR.

APOLLO (CONT'D)

I said mix! Not *blend*. You're
pulverizing the nutrients.

CHARY

It's a mixer.

APOLLO

That's the blender.
(shouting again)
And where is the GOD DAMN radish?

Mila, at the table, peeks up from phone. Directs her dad's
eyes to RADISH next to him. He deflates, grabs a knife.

MILA

This is *good*, Chary. We need to be
there for her. After everything,
she was brave enough to ask for
help. Sounds like she's grown up.

CHARY

Sounds like she's up to something.

MILA

Seriously? She lost her job.

CHARY

And?

APOLLO

And--
(CHOP)
She's my fucking daughter.

Silence. Mila looks back down at phone. Murmurs:

MILA
And it's what mom wants.

CHARY
Please, Mi. No more ghost stories.

Apollo ignores this, sits gently with Mila.

APOLLO
My miracle. What did she say?

MILA
That she belongs at home.

APOLLO
And?

Mila closes her eyes. Apollo waits patiently. Then she opens--

MILA
She's here.

EXT. DAY HOUSE - FRONT LAWN - NIGHT

Vera stares at the elegant craftsman house. Duffel in hand. Listens to the placid quiet of her affluent Del Mar youth.

House seems bigger than when she stormed out six years ago. But she feels familiar warmth as she steps to the door...

INT. DAY HOUSE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Vera sits between Chary and Mila. Mila's delighted to have her sister home. Chary's just delights in the awkwardness.

APOLLO (O.S.)
Almost forgot the Fez.

Apollo joins with an Ottoman-style Fez cap on head.

MILA
Oh my god, dad. We have a guest--
(to Vera)
Not that--you know what I mean.

Vera waves it off. Her sister may be a credulous moron, but she always tries to be nice...when Vera let's her.

APOLLO
This is no a stranger. Vera knows family tradition. And she knows your grandfather smuggled this--

CHARY	APOLLO (CONT'D)
<i>Over the Balkan Mountains.</i>	--over the Balkan Mountains.

Chary rolls eyes. Whispers mockingly to his siblings:

CHARY (CONT'D)
He bought it on Flatbush Avenue.

APOLLO
It's still tradition.

Sunny rushes in. Vera rises for a hug, stunned by his size.

Jesus. VERA

SUNNY
Only my fans call me that.

VERA
No. Sunny. You're enormous.

SUNNY
I know. I got the good genes.

MILA
How was Logan? You still stoned?

Apollo makes uneasy, fatherly mouth sounds as Sunny sits.

MILA (CONT'D)
Oh grow up, dad. It's California.

APOLLO
I'm not judging. I just prefer to
have some control over my brain.
(shouting)
Rita! We're all here!

SUNNY
There's no control. Only influence.

CHARY
Relax, Sun, no one's doing DMT with
you in a sensory deprivation tank.

MILA
Jim would.

SUNNY
Jim has.

APOLLO
Vera, do you know Jim Logan?

VERA
The podcast guy?

Apollo nods as Rita serves rainbows of vegetables.

VERA (CONT'D)
I mean I've never listened, but
everyone like...knows him.
(realizing)
Wait. Do you know Jim Logan?

APOLLO
Sure. I inspected his prostate.

CHARY
Dad, that's private patient
information.

APOLLO
What? We did it live on his show.
(leaning to Vera, proud)
Sunny recorded there today. And
Mila's the spiritual advisor for
Shi Shi Brown. You know her music?

Vera's eyes bug - *DUHHH*. Everyone does.

MILA
She'll be here tomorrow if you want
to, like, meet or something.

VERA
Wait, Mi. Are you like...more
famous than dad now?

CHARY
Dad has 17 Emmys.

SUNNY
And Mila has seven million
followers. I'm barely at one.

APOLLO
It's not a competition.

CHARY
Attention is finite. It is
absolutely a competition.

SUNNY
(to Vera)
Doesn't appeal to you?

Vera scowls at her vegetables.

APOLLO

We're working on her diet tomorrow.

She shoots Apollo a mortified look. *We are?*

SUNNY

I meant fame.

CHARY

Oh she's above all that.

VERA

No. There's just a cost, you know?
I mean, *Dad had a stalker.*

MILA

Same .

SUNNY

Same .

APOLLO

Doug was just looking for a friend.

VERA

I just couldn't handle the envy.

SUNNY

You don't want to be envied?

VERA

Want strangers feeling enraged when thinking about me and what I have?

(snort)

Only in America would that be considered a good thing.

MILA

That's right. It's the evil eye.

SUNNY

Like black magic?

MILA

Exactly.

VERA

Not at all.

Mila and Vera exchange a testy glance. Apollo pushes them on.

APOLLO

You know I was thinking about that Shaman from Brazil. Sayam.

MILA

Sehm.

VERA

Seyhem.

CHARY

His name was Sam.

APOLLO

Anyway, remember he spent hours
preparing that special tea...
(suppressing laughter)
...and as soon as it's ready...Vera
comes in and knocks it over?

BIG LAUGHS. Except Vera, who scrunches her face.

VERA

That was Chary.

APOLLO

No. You made apology brownies.

MILA

That was me. And they were lemon
squares. But I didn't spill.

CHARY

Who cares who spilled?

Apollo huffs.

Vera notices his offense, reaches to comfort--

Knocks RED JUICE on the carpet.

APOLLO

Rita! Seltzer and salt!

VERA

It's mom's afghan! Take it to a
professional before it sets!

CHARY

So you're a textile expert now?

Before Vera can snap back--

Rita runs in with seltzer and salt. Apollo dumps it on.

After a bit, he places a napkin on the wet area...

Pulls the RED out. Grins like a kid at Vera.

APOLLO

Try having a little faith, Vera.

VERA'S ROOM

Vera inspects the bizarre time capsule. Middle school science
fair trophies. Stuffed frogs. Polaroid collages.

Sits on twin bed. Grabs PHOTO of her gap-toothed mom, AYLA.

Grins somberly. Then turns to window. Reviews NEW ADDITIONS out back: Mila's poolhouse, staff cottage, and the garage now holding Chary's office above Apollo's studio. It's all new.

She grabs a bottle, heads out to explore.

INT. APOLLO'S STUDIO - NIGHT

Vera passes awards cases, photos with celebs and politicians.

OFFICE

Vera pokes around Apollo's LIBRARY OF VHS TAPES - 20 years of episodes, family home videos. Steps to a TV. Flips it on--

STILL PAUSED: the episode Apollo was watching earlier. PLAY.

ON TV

Apollo and Teen Vera laugh and cook pancakes. Then he lines up the commercial break:

APOLLO (ON TV)
We'll be back to taste our
creations...right after this!

Teen Vera packs her stuff up during the break.

APOLLO (ON TV) (CONT'D)
Vera, we're not finished yet.

TEEN VERA (ON TV)
Well I'm sorry, I have homework.

Apollo sighs, disappointed, as she walks off stage.

PRODUCER (ON TV, O.S.)
Did she leave? The network already
sold ads for the female teen demo.

VERA

narrows her eyes. Flips off the TV. Thought she was finished with the forced performances...

STAGE

Vera approaches two interview chairs on the cold stage. *Her dad's pulpit.* Sits in silence. Swigs her vodka.

SPOTLIGHTS nearly blind her.

CHARY (O.S.)
You know better than to bring
poison into his temple of purity.

Chary steps down from the sound booth with a cheeky grin.

VERA
You never used to tell on me.

CHARY
Well you're not 16 anymore.

He looks at the plastic bottle. SNORTS. *Or maybe you are.*
Then sits in the other chair, like it's an interview.

CHARY (CONT'D)
So. What's your world like these
days? You still talk to Silas?

VERA
Fell out of touch when I got to LA.
(skeptical sip)
Why? You come here to grill me?

CHARY
Dad actually said to make you feel
at home. Whatever that means.

VERA
He's just desperate for me to see
him as the good guy again.

CHARY
Aren't you a little old for good
guys and bad guys?

VERA
I don't know, Chary. What do you
think? Or are you too far up his
ass to have your own thoughts?

CHARY
I think anyone can act like a
saint. And everyone has the it in
them to be a monster.

VERA
Well I'd hate to meet the monster
you can be.

CHARY
And I truly hope you never do.

He grabs the bottle from her hands. Big GULP. They exchange a warm smirk. But it's still not sitting right for her.

VERA

I guess I'll just never understand
why you take orders from him.

CHARY

Because you don't remember it was
like without him. But I know how
lucky we are they found us. And you
- the luckiest of all. The apple of
his eye. His *great project*.

VERA

Doesn't that mean I'm his failure?

CHARY

(huff, then)

Dad doesn't believe in failure.

He polishes the bottle and heads off stage.

CHARY (CONT'D)

I'll get my stash upstairs. We can
get drunk while everyone's asleep.

VERA

I thought I wasn't 16 anymore.

AFTER ANOTHER BOTTLE

MUSIC BLASTS.

Hammered. Chary's in his undershirt, sipping fancy whisky.

Vera's poking around a storage closet...

Finds dozens of lifesize CARDBOARD CUTOUTS of Apollo.

VERA

He really keeps all these?

Chary staggers over. Grabs one.

CHARY

The man loves a memento.
(holding up cutout)
Hit it. It'll be therapeutic.

She SWIGS the bottle.

POPS it in the face. Doesn't feel as good as she thought.

LATER

Mila and Sunny investigate the BLASTING MUSIC in the studio.

Find Vera, dancing erratically--

And Chary on the floor, sorting through Apollo cutouts.

MILA

Does dad know you're drinking?

VERA

We're fucking adult women, Mila.

CHARY

He said to make her feel at home.

MILA

Getting sauced in the garage and making a mess. Like she never left.

VERA

Loosen up, Barbie. You're the one who's been on me to hang out.

MILA

You never text me back!

Vera puts an arm on her shoulder.

VERA

I never text anyone back. But we're here now, right?

Mila gets assuring nods from Chary, Sunny. Takes a breath.

MILA

Fine. We just don't really drink.

(to Sunny)

But maybe we can still have fun?

Sunny shrugs. Zips open his fanny pack. Takes out two PILLS.

Vera gawks at Chary, stunned.

VERA

You're cool with this?

CHARY

He's an adult.

VERA

Is he? I remember when he was a literal test-tube.

VERA (CONT'D)
(whispering to Sunny)
And I remember your lil' peenie.
(hand out)
Gimme.

Sunny and Mila make eye contact. Mila shakes her head.

VERA (CONT'D)
As your aunt, I am ordering you to
give me those drugs.

SUNNY
Vera. They don't mix with alcohol.

VERA
Then how do you explain this?

Vera snatches a pill from Sunny's hand. Pops it.

MORNING

Vera wakes up in a pile of Apollo's cutouts.

INT. DAY HOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Vera, brutally hungover, trudges in to find MURRY (30s, bearded stud-muffin) stacking veggies on a cutting board.

MURRY
Morning, Vera.

VERA
Uh...hi. Do I know you?

MURRY
I'm Murry, your dad's nutritionist.
He asked me to cover some cooking
basics with you so we can make
lunch later. And then to send you
over to the DayPur offices.
(grin)
You know he always talks about you.

VERA
Yeah right. What's he say?

MURRY
That your diet totally sucks.

VERA
Dude. Not now. It's just food.

MURRY

Please. You're smart enough to know
you are *literally* what you eat.

(passing cutting board)

So Vera. What would you like to be?

Vera makes eyes with him. Pops a defiant carrot in mouth.

APOLLO (PRE-LAP)

Resilient. Intelligent. Powerful.

INT. DAYPUR SCIENCE CENTER - PRODUCTION FLOOR - DAY

RAINBOWS of POWDERS and GOOS zip through clear pipes.

Apollo leads Vera on a Wonka-esque tour of the vitamin
production facility on the main floor of his corporate HQ.

APOLLO (CONT'D)

The body performs miracles.

VERA

So what are the pills for?

APOLLO

This one's for...

He hands her a pill. Waves over her: she looks like shit.

APOLLO (CONT'D)

Whatever's going on here.

VERA

Is it FDA approved?

APOLLO

It's parent approved.

He crosses his arms. She's in no position to be making
demands. And she'll try anything to make the pain stop.

APOLLO (CONT'D)

I developed that compound myself.

VERA

I thought you weren't involved in
day-to-day operations anymore--

ELEVATOR opens for SHY ROH (60s), a Black woman in an
athleisure pantsuit with lean arms and sharp movements.

APOLLO

Vera, you remember my CEO, Shy Roh.

VERA

Yeah, I mean. It's been years.

Shy towers over Vera.

SHY

I'd say you've grown so much but...

Vera chuckles - polite, but genuine. There's warmth here.

SHY (CONT'D)

So. What's next on the tour?

APOLLO

The lab.

Shy throws Apollo a concerned look.

He shakes his head - *not that one*. Shy relaxes.

APOLLO (CONT'D)

Actually do you mind taking her
there? Need something in my office.

STORAGE ROOM

Apollo slips into a refrigerated storage room. Opens a cabinet with VIALS.

Slips one in his jacket.

ELEVATOR

Shy and Vera ride. Vera's feeling better. But it's awkward.

VERA

Listen. I know this might be...
weird or whatever. But I want you
to know, all the stuff I've said
about my dad and my mom, and
everything with the company...it
has nothing to do with you.

SHY

This is my company now, Vera.
Everything has to do with me.
(letting her squirm)
But. If it makes you feel better,
you should know that your criticism
has been...*registered*.

Vera squints. Really? Shy nods.

SHY (CONT'D)
 You may find it difficult to believe, but we've bolstered R&D practices and raised standards of evidence for all our products. And as for your dad...well...he's on the cusp of truly great things.

VERA
That is more difficult to believe.

SHY
 Then have some patience, Vera.

DING! Elevator doors open.

SHY (CONT'D)
 You just got here.

ANIMAL RESEARCH LAB

Apollo shows Vera a SLEEPING RAT in a cage.

APOLLO
 This is Randi.
 (finger to lips)
 He's sleeping. And suffering from neurodegeneration similar to my own Alzheimer's disease.

He picks up a TABLET with a BRAIN SCAN - splotched in RED.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
 Red shows the waste his brain fails to clear during sleep. It's what eats away at his...and my...memory.
 (proud)
 What our treatment does is induce sleep so deep that it not only clears the waste, but even *enhances* memory consolidation.
 (anticipating)
 Save your questions.

She has a million, but bites her tongue.

He swipes to Randi's LATEST BRAIN SCAN:

GREEN DOTS are replacing the red.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
 This is Randi now. You can see the red is fading. He's healing.

VERA
What's the green?

APOLLO
The treatment targets the specific
areas where memories are stored.
And it leaves it's mark after
repairing the damage.

She processes, slow. At that stage of a hangover where the
brain has less practical restrictions, more flexibility.

VERA
So we can see his memories?

APOLLO
Where they are, I guess. Of course
there's no way to actually
visualize the content.

VERA
But it's just data. So in theory,
if you had sophisticated enough
imaging and analysis software, you
could like...deduce the patterns
and reconstruct them. Then like,
watch the memories. Right?

APOLLO
Sure, Vera
(mocking chuckle)
In theory.

VERA
Dad. This is incredible.

APOLLO
I'm glad you're opening your mind.

VERA
No, I mean: it's *not credible*.

APOLLO
Why? Because it hasn't been blessed
by some make-work bureaucrat?
(annoyed)
I don't have time for that, Vera.

She takes her time to process. Then clams up.

VERA
Wait. You're not seriously...

He puckers lips. *You bet he fucking is*. She's blown away.

VERA (CONT'D)
You can't *cure yourself*.

APOLLO
And why is that?

VERA
To start, you're a neurosurgeon.
Not a researcher. You're not
trained to manage these types of
clinical trials.

APOLLO
But my daughter is.

Vera freezes.

VERA
Wait. *This* is why I'm here?

APOLLO
I'm sorry. Are you too busy to help
save your father's life?

VERA
Save your life? What the fuck are
you talking about?

She paces manically, grabbing at her hair.

VERA (CONT'D)
Anybody can inject a rat, dad. But
the timelines don't even work.
It'll be years just to get to large
animal trials. *Let alone* humans.
And by that point, you'll be...

Vera trails off. Head spinning. Apollo's losing patience.

APOLLO
You don't think I know that? I'm
running as fast as I can here.
Working with what I have.

VERA
Which is what exactly?

APOLLO
You'll see. When you're ready.

VERA
I'm ready now.

APOLLO
No, Vera.
(hand on shoulder)
Now is lunch.

INT. DAY HOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

DARKNESS. POV from the OVEN.

APOLLO (O.S.)
It's hot. Use the mitts.

VERA (O.S.)
Don't baby me.

Door opens. Hand reaches in. BURNS. Dish drops.

CRASH!

AT THE TABLE

Vera, Apollo, and Murry finish the frittata. Glass picked out. Vera's feeling better. But still a little loopy.

MURRY
Thanks to the chef.

VERA
I'm thanking Rita for these
immaculate floors.

They all smile at Rita, on her hands and knees, reaching for the remaining glass that flew under the fridge.

APOLLO
The thanks goes to the teacher.

MURRY
Please. She already knew how to do
most of it. She's just lazy.

VERA
See? This one gets me.

MURRY
She'll be fully veg in no time.

VERA
I retract that statement.

MURRY
Why? This is even better than mine.

VERA

You wouldn't say that if I wasn't
the boss's daughter.

MURRY

Well I'll have to make it for you
some time to prove I'm not lying.

Vera throws him soft eye contact. *Gladly.*

MURRY (CONT'D)

So Vera, are you still studying...
what was it? Molecular Biology?

VERA

I actually finished the PhD.

MURRY

Wonderful. So you're working?

Vera shoves food in to avoid responding. Apollo steps in:

APOLLO

She will. But academia - it's a
brutal market.

Murry smiles polite. Waits appropriate amount of time. Rises.

MURRY

Alright. That's it for me. I'll be
back later to see Mila. Enjoy the
rest of your day, you two.

Vera's gaze lingers on him as he heads off.

VERA

He works with Mila too?

APOLLO

Sure. He helps her. She helps him.

VERA

How? By talking to his dead cat?

Apollo purses lips, disappointed.

APOLLO

You should give your sister more
credit. She has a lot to offer.

INT. MILA'S POOLHOUSE - RECORDING STUDIO - DAY

Mila counsels crying popstar SHI SHI BROWN (20s).

MILA

I'm here for you. Which means your mom is here for you too. But just remember, there's no perspective without distance. And without perspective, there's no discovery.

LIVING ROOM

Vera slinks into the millennial pink living room to find Shi Shi's 7-piece ENTOURAGE on the sofa, staring at phones.

VERA

Hey. I'm uh, Mila's sister. Are you all with, um, uh...Shi Shi?

They all look up skeptically.

ENTOURAGE 1

You don't look like Mila.

ENTOURAGE 2

No one asked you, Saya!
 (whispering to Vera)
 Sorry, that's Shi Shi's astrologist. You know how things get at this part of the cycle...
 (shaking Vera's hand)
 I'm her nutritionist, Jesse.

They all look back down as #2 introduces them one by one.

ENTOURAGE 2 (CONT'D)

That's her trainer, Ocean. Her herbalist, Lita. Her belly fat consultant, Oz. And I think Jeff deals with like, the tax stuff.

#7 stares right into Vera's eyes:

ENTOURAGE 7

And I handle the dark energies.

EXT. GARDEN - DAY

Vera exhales when she gets outside. Gazes around--

Hedges SPIRAL out from a GAZEBO, forming a labyrinth.

She takes it in. It's all new. After a bit:

Shi Shi steps out with a weed pen. PUFFS. Offers to Vera.

SHI SHI
Seems like you could use it.

Vera's frozen. Gawking. This is a legit fucking celebrity.

VERA
I'm more of a fermented sugar girl.

SHI SHI
Shit. Liquor wrecks my memory.

VERA
I know. I love it too.

Shi Shi snorts. Smiles wide as she shakes Vera's hand.

SHI SHI
I'm Sheela.

VERA
Oh, I know...I'm sort of like...a
big fan or whatever? Is that a
weird thing to say?

SHI SHI
Relax. Mimi told me all about you.
(looking around property)
Must've been nice growing up here.

VERA
It wasn't always like this. But I
guess it had its moments.

Shi Shi squints at the spoiled curmudgeon. Blows vapor ring.

SHI SHI
I'm sure most folks would kill for
a few of those moments.

Embarrassed, Vera changes the topic.

VERA
How is it working with my sister?

SHI SHI
How is it? She changed my life.

VERA
Right. My dad calls her a miracle.

SHI SHI
And. What do you call her?

Vera bites her tongue. Shi Shi giggles at her squirming.

SHI SHI (CONT'D)
Relax. Like I said: she told me all
about you.

Vera opens her mouth, then closes it.

SHI SHI (CONT'D)
I know what you wanna ask. And it's
alright. You can ask.

VERA
I don't know what you're--

SHI SHI
Come on, science fair. You wanna
know if I think it's really real,
don't you? Mila talking to my mom.

Vera bites her inner lip. Of course she does!

Shi Shi puffs her pen. Empties a CLOUD.

SHI SHI (CONT'D)
Listen. I don't know if it's like,
true, or whatever. But it helps. A
lot. And that's real enough for me.

Vera processes. *Does she have a point?*

Mila saunters over. Puts an arm over Shi Shi.

MILA
Don't mind Vera. Full moon's in
Pisces. Everyone's a bit on edge.

SHI SHI
Maybe you could help her.

MILA
Oh she's got her reality figured
out. She wouldn't be open to that.

GAZEBO

Vera took the bait. Now she lays her head on Mila's lap.

VERA
I can't believe I'm doing this.

MILA
Well you are. So commit to the work
and think positive thoughts. What
are you grateful for?

Vera wavers.

MILA (CONT'D)
Come on. Your life's a gift. And
you're back home with family. I
know circumstances are...but think
what would have happened if you
didn't have dad's safety net.

Vera sits up, angry.

VERA
I don't want his money.

MILA
What's the big deal, Vera? He made
it helping people.

VERA
He made it selling morons magic
weight loss beans.

MILA
Okay. This energy is *totally* wrong.

Mila purses her lips. Thinks of something positive.

MILA (CONT'D)
I hear you met Murry.

Vera settles. Let's her have this one.

VERA
Yeah. Yeah. He's like, kinda great.

MILA
I knew you two would hit it off.

Warm moment. Positivity set.

Mila pushes her back down.

MILA (CONT'D)
Good. Now close your eyes. And
resist the urge to overthink.

VERA
So do you follow like a certain
philosophy or school of thought?

MILA
Vera.

Vera sighs. Closes her eyes. Mila rocks her back and forth.

MILA (CONT'D)
You're on a boat. Mist on your
face. Picture the land in front of
you. Where is it? What do you see?

VERA
My eyes are closed.

MILA
So open them.
(covering preemptively)
Not literally. Just look.

VERA
It's just...dark.

MILA
Find the light. What do you see?

VERA
(trying to play ball)
I guess...the beach out front?

MILA
Good. Who's there?
(getting nothing)
Vera. Look.

Vera takes a breath. She can fake it...

VERA
Uh. I see you. Chary. Dad. Sunny.

MILA
Who else?

VERA
No one.

MILA
Then keep looking.

Silence...then Vera JOLTS.

She POPS UP. Breath racing. Mila's ecstatic.

MILA (CONT'D)
Who'd you see?

VERA
No one. It was just in my head.

MILA
Duh. Where else would it be?

INT. DAY HOUSE - APOLLO'S ROOM - DAY

Apollo watches his daughters from the window. Smiles.

Catches his REFLECTION. Spots a new wrinkle. Tries to rub it out like a smudge from the window. Harder, harder. Breathing heavy. Gives up. There's nothing he can do. For now.

INT. LOCAL TV NEWS SET - DAY

GUY, a local news host, interviews Silas.

GUY

And we're back with Professor Silas Kartal, author of the new book:

QUACKS: A Field Guide to
Contemporary Pseudoscience.

(to Silas)

Professor, your book takes specific aim at TV legend Dr. Apollo. Why did you decide to focus on him?

SILAS

Apollo perfectly illustrates the book's ideas. But frankly, he's nothing unique. The work he does is part of a long tradition of faith healers that predates evidence-based medicine by millennia.

GUY

Is it related to the fact that he's the widower of your father's late sister, Ayla Kartal?

SILAS

Of course. In fact, it was his behavior during my aunt's final days that moved me to write on the subject in the first place. Because the raw truth is: when she was most vulnerable, he pushed the best specialists out of the room so he could use her as a Guinea pig to prove his own genius. And conflicted or not, I have a basic responsibility to hold my own family accountable--

INT. DAY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Chary and Apollo steam as they watch Silas on TV.

SILAS (CONT'D)
Like we all do.

Apollo MUTES. Pinches temples.

APOLLO
How did you not see this coming?

CHARY
He's smart. He kept it quiet.

APOLLO
You can just say you didn't do your
fucking job.

He storms off. Yells into the hall.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
Family meeting! Now!

DINING ROOM

Apollo addresses Mila, Sunny, and Chary at the table.

APOLLO
The line for the interview tomorrow
morning is: this has been planned
for the show's 20th anniversary.
It's unrelated to Silas's book.

SUNNY
Popop, no one we care about cares
about Professor Dumbledick anyway.

VERA
He just wants attention.

Chary flashes Vera a skeptical look.

CHARY
How do you know what he wants?

APOLLO
This is an announcement, not a
discussion. I've instructed Darcy
to dig in on the points from his
book. We answer each charge. This
family doesn't hide from anything.
Vera, will you join?

Vera opens her mouth...uhhhh--

SECURITY steps in with a serious face.

SECURITY

Someone's out front checking cars
and windows. Everyone stay here.

Chary jumps up.

CHARY

I told you we need a fence, dad.
And more than one toy soldier.

APOLLO

This isn't a fortress. It's a home.

Chary rolls eyes, heads off. Barks at Security:

CHARY

Stay with them.

EXT. DAY HOUSE - FRONT LAWN - DAY

MATEO (late 20s, wispy) peers in a car window.

CHARY (O.S.)

You have 30 seconds.

In the REFLECTION: CHARY'S FACE appears behind Mateo.

CHARY (CONT'D)

Identity yourself and establish no
intention to harm us. And I won't
exercise my legal right to defend
our persons and property.

MATEO

Shit man. Do you have a gun?

CHARY

Please. This is California.
(pressing on his back)
But it's still America. 20 seconds
to explain. You better start.

MATEO

I'm a journalist. Mateo. Lima.
Please don't hurt me.

CHARY

With who? 15 seconds.

MATEO

(frantic)
Just freelance. But an editor told
me to try to get an interview.

CHARY

You think he talks to just anyone who shows up? You have to earn his attention like everyone else.

MATEO

I know, man. I'm not here for him.

Chary catches his eye in the reflection. Hm.

INT. CHARY'S OFFICE - DAY

Mateo sits across from Chary with a notebook.

CHARY

Have you ever done this before?

MATEO

An interview?

CHARY

An interview with someone like me.

MATEO

I'm no selfish lover, if that's what you're asking.

Chary taps his teeth. Gestures to proceed.

MATEO (CONT'D)

Let's start with the Institute. Tax records put the endowment at \$325m. But it's just you here full time.

CHARY

That's not a question.

Chary's harsh eyes say move on. Mateo flips his notebook.

MATEO

Okay. DayPur. Your dad's business--

CHARY

It's not his business.

MATEO

It's named after him.

CHARY

Shy Roh runs day-to-day operations.

MATEO

You gotta give something.

CHARY

I can't do your job for you, Mateo.
You have to investigate your
subject on your own.

MATEO

I told you. You're my subject.

CHARY

Stories change. It's on you to
follow where it leads.

He's not following. Chary takes notebook. Scribbles.

CHARY (CONT'D)

Of course you'll need to keep your
audience apprised of critical
details. Like where *he goes*. And
who he talks to. And if the work is
quality, I think you'll find us to
be particularly generous partners.
(handing back notebook)
Here's your first tip.

Mateo, confused, reads: "SILAS KARTAL + FLORIDA".

INT. APOLLO'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Next morning. Apollo, Mila, Sunny, and Chary on sofa.

No Vera. Darcy welcomes back the audience. Cameras roll.

DARCY

We're back with Dr. Apollo and his
family of Days. But today, we also
honor family no longer with us.
(to camera)

I'm of course referring to Apollo's
late wife. Who, after years of
infertility, tragically passed
after the miraculous birth of Mila.

APOLLO

Ayla is still with us.

Mila gives him an encouraging hand squeeze.

APOLLO (CONT'D)

She's just not *here* right now.

DARCY

You've said it was her death that
put you on this path.

APOLLO

That's correct. Ayla was a fine researcher in her own right. So when she got sick--

(choking up)

When she got sick, and we didn't understand what was happening...we just felt so...*helpless*. Only then did I realize an entirely new approach to medicine was needed.

DARCY

An approach you've often described in religious terms.

APOLLO

Sure. I have my beliefs, you have yours. The goal is to introduce a sort of *pluralism* into the field. Less certainty, more possibility.

KITCHEN

Vera's digging into the spread when Murry enters with a bouquet of herbs and greens.

She shoves food down, fixes hair. Acts casual.

VERA

What are you doing here?

MURRY

Just stopping by to help Mila. Are they almost finished?

VERA

I think they're about to break for lunch. What's that?

MURRY

Oh. Just some herbs and leafy greens...actually for you.

She's in awe of the gesture. He waves it away.

MURRY (CONT'D)

Relax, Vera. It's my job.

Vera steps to him. Feels his warm breath on her lip.

VERA

Is it, though?

She turns up...eye to eye...

ELECTRICITY RIPPLES--

MILA (O.S.)
IS THAT FOR MIII?

He jumps back.

Mila runs in to KISS Murry.

Vera goes pale. Turns to jet out...BUMPS right into Darcy.

DARCY
The prodigal princess! Not sure if
you remember me. But we did that
cooking spot when you were a kid.

VERA
(trying to get by)
Yeah. Right. I forgot about that.

DARCY
Well America certainly didn't.

Vera halts, scrunches nose.

DARCY (CONT'D)
I was just a producer then. But we
were so bummed we didn't get to
finish the second episode. The
first was a huge hit. It's actually
what convinced the network to sign
your dad to a long term deal.

VERA Really? MILA Really?

Mila's interest is officially piqued. She saunters over.

DARCY
Really. Mila's not the only
daughter who's got *it*. Why don't
you join us for the second half?

VERA I can't. MILA She can't.

DARCY
It'd really help your dad with
this...cousin thing.

Darcy reads Vera's hesitation.

DARCY (CONT'D)
No need to discuss the past or
where you've been or any of that.
We can just make a vague reference
to your 'foreign volunteer work'.

VERA
I never volunteered abroad.

DARCY
And I never studied journalism. But
this is TV, sugar. Whatever we say
on that screen...
(wink)
Is the truth.

Darcy leans into whisper:

DARCY (CONT'D)
You're not going to let your little
sister get all the shine, are you?

LIVING ROOM

Vera sits with the rest as cameras roll. Big fake smile.

DARCY
Vera - how does it feel being home
with your whole family?

VERA
It's amazing, Darcy. To see what
they've all accomplished.

DARCY
And who's impressed you the most?

VERA
I'd have to say Mila. Building a
brand from nothing is incredible.

She exchanges warm smiles with Mila. She can do this.

DARCY
Right. But some say her work
communing with the departed - well,
you tell us...

VERA
I can tell you she's bringing
people relief. I've seen it myself.

Apollo shoots a look at Darcy. *Get to the meat.*

DARCY

And your father. It's no secret
you've disagreed with his work in
the past. How do you feel now?

VERA

We all have different ways of
finding the truth.

DARCY

So you believe what he says on his
show is the truth?

VERA

Who's to decide what's true?

DARCY

As a scientist, presumably...you.

VERA

That's a common misconception.
Science doesn't say what's "true".
It works to prove what's false.

Vera crosses her legs. This is easier than she thought.
Apollo's delighted. Mila's impressed. Good work all around.

DARCY

Well. Your cousin Silas writes that
many of your father's claims are
deliberately *unfalsifiable*. That he
refuses to adhere to same burden of
proof that science demands.

Vera catches Apollo's eye, who nods to go on.

VERA

He's doing what he thinks is right.

DARCY

Sure, but people are making life or
death decisions based on - as you
put it - *what he thinks is right*.
Is that a good idea?

She opens her mouth, then closes it. Apollo flushes red.

DARCY (CONT'D)

Vera? Would you recommend that?

HALLWAY

Apollo catches Darcy packing up.

APOLLO
What the hell was that?

DARCY
I lined it up for simple yes's and
no's. Clean leading questions.

APOLLO
Well you led her the wrong way.

DARCY
Apollo. I don't work for you.

APOLLO
But you're not working without me.
(storming off)
Cut the end. Send to me for final
cut. And don't fuck around again.

VERA'S ROOM

Vera sits on the floor. Pages through a PHOTO ALBUM. Photos
of her and her dad in the happy days...with her mom.

She turns up to Apollo, leaning against the door, meek.

VERA
I'm sorry I'm not a better liar.

APOLLO
Just being there is enough to show
I welcome criticism.

VERA
But do you?

APOLLO
I brought you to the lab, didn't I?

VERA
Yet you managed to tell me nothing.

APOLLO
Vera, it's complicated.

VERA
The only reason to make the truth
complicated is to disguise a lie.

APOLLO
What am I lying about?

Apollo follows her eyes to the photo of her MOM. Damn.

Then sits on the bed, above her. Considers how to put this...

 APOLO
Every family has their fables.

 VERA
You can't just make shit up.

 APOLLO
Are you my daughter?

Vera nods, slow.

 APOLLO (CONT'D)
Is Chary my son?

She nods again. More skeptical.

 APOLLO (CONT'D)
Well that's all made up. Our family
is made up. We're just fragments.
The stories are what make us whole.

 VERA
And what's my story, dad?

He looks at her for a while. Then stands, holds out his hand--

INT. APOLLO'S STUDIO - OFFICE - DAY

Vera waits as Apollo selects a tape from his library.

 APOLLO
Nearly 30 years ago, we went to
Turkey. Near your mom's hometown.
We were searching for a miracle.

 VERA
Did you find it?

Apollo nods. Slots the tape in the VCR. Hits PLAY--

 APOLLO
Vera. We found you.

ON TV

Same footage from the CAMCORDER after the earthquake in Turkey, but starting AFTER the jeep crushed the house:

Bloodied, the gap-toothed woman (AYLA) rushes to a trapped little girl (VERA). As she pulls her out, Ayla spots something GREEN in the rubble...rushes over to inspect.

VERA

struggles to form words. Eventually, she mutters:

VERA
You think that's gonna save you?

APOLLO
You saw it yourself.

VERA
I saw a rat. And I told you: it's
not enough time. At least three
years to human trials. And by then--

Apollo looks her in the eye, speaks sharply:

APOLLO
And I told you: I'm running as fast
as I can.

INT. DAYPUR SCIENCE CENTER - ANIMAL RESEARCH LAB - DAY

Randi the rat paces his cage.

APOLLO (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Working with what I have.

On the tablet: the BRAIN SCAN is ENTIRELY GREEN.

INT. DAY HOUSE - VERA'S ROOM - DAY

Vera slams the door behind her. Collapses on her bed. Plays
it over in her head. *This is insane*. Reaches for liquor--

BUZZ BUZZ. It's Silas calling. She GROANS.

INT./EXT. SILAS'S CAR - DAY

Silas and Vera sit in his car by beach.

SILAS
Sorry I didn't mention the book. I
couldn't risk them gumming it up.

VERA
You think I would have squealed?

SILAS
I don't know. After seeing you
dance for them on TV...

VERA
I'm trying to repair things, Silas.
They're my family.

SILAS
So am I. But I'm not asking you to
disregard everything you believe.

VERA
Please. Not everything's so binary.

He gawks at her. She sounds like Apollo. Or Chary.

SILAS
How did they get to you?

She turns away. Obviously can't mention her dad's illness or
what she just saw on tape...

VERA
Just tell me what you want.

SILAS
That's not why I called, Vera. I'm
here to give.

Vera turns back, suppressing intrigue. He takes his shot.

SILAS (CONT'D)
We both know you deserve to be more
than just some famous guy's
shittiest kid. But we also both
know you're never getting a real
job with plagiarism on your record.

VERA
And I thought we both knew that was
all fucking bullshit.

SILAS
It looks how it looks, Vera. And it
looks bad. But luckily, your cousin
has dedicated his life to exposing
malicious lies.

VERA
And the cost of his services?

SILAS
Accountability. Evidence your dad
knows his claims are unfounded. He
seems to trust you now.

She looks down. Days ago she'd have jumped at this. Now...

VERA
He's an old man, Silas. I don't
think he's still capable of
whatever it is you're imagining.

SILAS
Vera. He's a megalomaniac who
killed your fucking mom...
(into her eyes)
What do you think he's capable of?

INT. DAYPUR SCIENCE CENTER - ANIMAL RESEARCH LAB - NIGHT

Apollo and Shy peer into Randi's cage. He's dead. And green.

SHY
Do I need to be worried?

APOLLO
It's a rat. They die all the time.

SHY
And the others?

APOLLO
We press on. Continue to rewrite
their fate. Why?
(reading her face)
Do you no longer trust me?

SHY
After Bring Your Aggrieved Daughter
to Work Day? I'm having my doubts.

APOLLO
She can help us. All of us. Once
she sees the whole picture.

He removes Randi from cage. Lays the carcass on counter.

SHY
And. What if you're wrong?

APOLLO
This is science, Shy.

He pulls out a big knife.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
Being wrong is half the job.

CHOPS THE HEAD OFF.

INT. CHARY'S OFFICE - NIGHT

Mateo bites nails as Chary pages through his report on Silas.

MATEO

Article drops tonight. The editor
is ecstatic. Already wants more.

CHARY

Keep it up. And you'll get more.

Chary turns to PHOTOS of Silas meeting people.

Flips through to the last photo. Freezes. Grinds teeth.

MATEO

Is something wrong?

CHARY

Just leave. I'll be in touch.

Mateo carefully steps out of the room. Once he's gone:

Chary SLAMS his desk. Grabs his keys.

INT. DAYPUR SCIENCE CENTER - LOBBY - NIGHT

Chary waits at elevator. Sees one COMING UP from B.

DOORS OPEN. Apollo and Shy step out.

CHARY

Dad. I've been looking for you.

APOLLO

Apologies. We were just finishing a
meeting upstairs. You know how the
service can be up there. Mind
giving me a lift home?

Chary narrows his eyes. They just came up...not down.

But he's got bigger fish to fry right now.

INT. CHARY'S CAR - NIGHT

Chary drives, quietly furious. Apollo babbles happily.

APOLLO

...so proud of you, Chary. How you
set ego aside to make Vera feel at
home. I hope you see it now.

APOLLO (CONT'D)

How beautiful it can be when we're all together. I can't remember the last time I felt like this.

CHARY

So do you trust her?

APOLLO

Of course. She's my kid.

(suddenly concerned)

Why? Did something happen? Is that what you wanted to talk about?

Chary peeks at his dad. He can't ruin this for him now.

CHARY

No. It's just Silas. The article will be online tonight.

APOLLO

And? Who's he talking to?

Chary clears his throat. Keeps eyes to the road.

CHARY

We'll find out. Need some time.

APOLLO

So you trust this writer guy?

CHARY

If we keep him fed.

EXT. GARDEN - GAZEBO - NIGHT

Vera stares at the house. Still processing. Still stunned. Still confused. Sips vodka from the last bottle.

Chary arrives. Sits slow. She offers vodka. He turns it down.

CHARY

Vera. What are you doing here?

VERA

Just needed some fresh air.

CHARY

No. Why did you really come home?

(reading her eyes)

And don't give me that dogshit about paying rent. I talked to Fair-Drug. I know they're scared enough of dad to hire you back.

VERA
Chary. You're being paranoid.

He pulls out a PHOTO of her and Silas. Drops on her lap.

CHARY
I'm just doing my job.

Vera chokes on a melon-sized gulp. Stammers:

VERA
That's--that's not it.

CHARY
Then what is it, Vera?

She's trapped. Can't reveal Apollo's secrets. Just exhales.

CHARY (CONT'D)
You know, when dad said you were
coming home, I knew something was
off. I was just trying to be a good
brother. And I know I'm no saint--
(through teeth)
But only you could make trying to
be good such a god damn mistake.

They stew in silence until:

VERA
Will you tell dad?

Chary looks at her with reddening eyes. Shakes his head.

VERA (CONT'D)
Why not?

CHARY
Because it would kill him. He's
staked everything on making things
normal again. For some reason I
can't figure out, he truly wants
you here.

VERA
And? What do you want?

CHARY
For you to pick a team already.

This cuts the wrong way. She sharpens her tone, defiant.

VERA
And if I don't?

CHARY
Then you *will* meet him, Vera.

VERA
Who?

He turns up to her. Eyes streaked in crimson.

CHARY
The monster.

INT. UNIVERSITY - SILAS'S OFFICE - NIGHT

Silas stares at computer. Flabbergasted. On it, an article:

ACCLAIMED USD PROFESSOR ON FLORIDA SEX OFFENDER REGISTRY

SILAS
Linda, it's not me. I haven't even
been to Florida since I was eight.
It's just a guy with the same name!

He looks up, desperate, to an ADMIN.

ADMIN
It looks how it looks. And it looks
bad, Silas.

SILAS
It's *meant* to look bad. You are
getting played.

ADMIN
Relax. The truth always comes out
eventually. We'll be in touch.

ADMIN heads out.

He SLAPS the computer monitor, toppling it.

EXT. DAY HOUSE - VERA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Vera ZIPS her duffel as Apollo stands in shock.

APOLLO
What happened?

VERA
This was a mistake. I'm leaving.

APOLLO
Vera, please. You can't leave now.
I believe we are on the cusp of
something truly incredible.

VERA
Then you're losing your mind.

Apollo blows:

APOLLO
I know!
(settling himself)
That's why I need you to stay.

Vera seethes at him.

VERA
I knew it. This is your way of
punishing me. You just want me to
be here to watch you die.

APOLLO
I have no plans on dying, Vera.

VERA
The disease doesn't care about your
FUCKING PLANS dad.

She falls back on her bed. Looks at ceiling.

VERA (CONT'D)
I told you.

A tear finally leaks out as she deflates.

VERA (CONT'D)
I'm telling you: it's too late.

APOLLO
And I'm asking you, Vera...

Apollo leans over her eyeline.

APOLLO (CONT'D)
What if you're wrong?

He holds out his hand--

INT. DAYPUR SCIENCE CENTER - ELEVATOR - NIGHT

Shy swipes her keycard--

Opens a latch to reveal a hidden button: B. She presses.
Elevator goes down...

BASEMENT LAB

Shy steps into the quiet lab. Looks like a hospital ward.
Older patients sleep in beds.
She approaches LYRA ROH (94). Sits. Strokes her mom's hair.
Then grabs a TABLET clipped to the bed.

INT. APOLLO'S STUDIO - OFFICE - NIGHT

Apollo struggles to connect his laptop to the MONITOR.

VERA
Whatever this is, just show me so I
can leave.

He snorts as he searches for the right port.

APOLLO
I can't just *show* you, Vera. Like
anything important in this life,
you need to do it yourself.

INT. DAYPUR SCIENCE CENTER - BASEMENT LAB - NIGHT

On the tablet: Shy reviews Lyra's BRAIN SCAN--
It's dotted with GREEN.

VERA (V.O.)
Do what?

INT. DAY HOUSE - APOLLO'S STUDY - NIGHT

Apollo connects the monitor.
Vera looks up to his BRAIN SCAN--

APOLLO
Open your fucking eyes.

It's entirely covered in green.

CUT TO BLACK.

VERA (PRE-LAP)
That's not what happened.

INT. STUDIO - DAY (30 YEARS LATER)

Vera (30 years older), Mila (hasn't aged), Chary (gray in wheelchair), and Sunny (deep surgical scars) sit on a sofa.

Uncomfortable. Haven't seen one another in years.

They've been watching everything up until now on a MONITOR.

PRODUCER (O.S.)
It's not just your story, Vera.
Every living Day contributed
memories to this documentary.

Monitor now displays:

FOUR BRAIN SCANS--

All dotted with GREEN.

PRODUCER (O.S.) (CONT'D)
There's bound to be conflict. And
trust me, the audience will be
eager for us to get to the
discrepancies. But first--

NEW MEMORIES start to roll on the monitor...

PRODUCER (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Let us see what happened next.